BENNETT'S WALLABY

Macropus rufogriseus

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Each ear turns on its own, wide eyes see almost all around, and its feet feel ground vibrations.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives in eucalypt forest with open grassy spots — shade to rest and grass to graze.

3. How does it send messages?
It thumps a back foot to warn other wallabies, and a heavy, fast hop tells the group to scatter.

4. What does it do when something changes?
It rests in shade during the hottest part of the day and hops into thick brush when scared.

5. How does it learn?
A joey travels in its mother's pouch and watches what she eats before grazing on its own.

6. How does it have babies?
A tiny newborn crawls into the pouch and grows there, nursing for about nine months.

7. What are its limits?
It needs both open grass and dense cover, so clearing the forest leaves it exposed to dogs.

8. What does this teach us?
Its daily routine is timed around heat, not just hunger — environment shapes its whole day.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Bennett's wallabies live in the forests and grasslands of eastern Australia and Tasmania.

Fires, drought, and land clearing keep reshaping their habitat.

Roads, fences, and new development keep them cut off from old paths.

When its habitat shrinks:

- food becomes patchy after major bushfires
- family groups are split by roads and fenced land
- predators like feral cats and foxes make survival harder

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If your back legs were your main way to move, how would you choose a safe place to rest?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

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